



MONTHLY UPDATE

Madagascar: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 15 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-09 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The first phase of biometric enrolment closed with [more than six million adults registered against a two-million target](#), and the day after that was reported the electoral commission [opened a full reconstitution of the electoral roll, gated on presentation of a national identity card](#).

The Council of Ministers of 8 July did two things on the same day: it [adopted a bill overhauling the 2014 cyber law](#) and it [ordered internet service providers to block pornographic sites, with no timetable, mechanism, named regulator or appeal route](#).

The national police [opened a public reporting platform for violence and disappearances on 28 July](#) with no data controller, retention rule or supervisory authority named, and MVola's new director general [gave the first account of the platform migration that broke the country's dominant payment rail](#).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 11 July 2026 SpaceX ran [Madagascar's first Direct-to-Cell satellite trial at Sadabe](#), on Airtel's spectrum and following an [FCC notice filed on 13 May](#) — the third African country after Kenya and Uganda. Commercial launch is pending the national regulator.

On 23 July Yas Madagascar [ran a 5G-Advanced trial with Huawei at its Andraharo campus](#), pitching the network as a substrate for artificial intelligence, augmented reality and connected devices. The operator claims to be the fourth in the world to test the technology; the claim is its own. The posts and digital development minister attended and tied it to public-service delivery, learning, health and enterprise access. No commercial 5G service is on record.

Digital public infrastructure

Digital Identity and CRVS

On 27 July the interior ministry reviewed the first phase of adult biometric registration, reporting [more than six million people enrolled against a two-million target across April to June 2026](#). A second phase is in preparation, supported by the World Bank-financed DECIM project. No cost figure for either phase is reported.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 3 August MVola's new director general [gave the first account of the platform migration behind the outages of May and June](#). The core platform was replaced in May 2026; he states that money does not vanish from accounts, that reported cases have been regularised, and that the platform is stabilised with further work outstanding. No regulator is named, no incident report is published and no compensation is mentioned. Separately, [Airtel Money integrated Baobab Bank into its mobile banking service on 17 July](#).

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

The day after the biometric-registration review, the electoral commission [opened a full reconstitution of the electoral roll at Talata Volonondry](#) – a rebuild rather than the routine revision – running four months to 24 November 2026, to produce the single roll for all elections and referendums scheduled in 2027. The trigger is stated: the previous roll drew sustained contestation and is named as a source of tension at earlier polls. Registration runs through five channels, at fokontany level on presentation of a national identity card. The commission states that an unregistered citizen may not observe polling in their own place of residence and may not lodge a complaint or contest results.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 28 July the national police [presented a free public reporting platform at Anosy](#), six days after the national day of mourning of 24 July that followed a run of kidnappings and killings. Built by the police's own information-systems directorate, it runs 24 hours a day on web and an Android application in Malagasy and French, taking reports of gender-based violence and of disappearances of children, adults and people with albinism. Reports may be filed anonymously, an automatically generated reference number lets a declarant track the file, and reports are triaged by specialist services before routing. Its scope is [explicitly digital](#): online harassment, non-consensual image sharing, sextortion, online defamation and AI-falsified content are reportable categories in their own right. No data controller, retention rule or supervisory authority is named.

On 3 August the higher-education ministry [presented an accreditation platform](#) centralising applications for authorisation, accreditation and equivalence and letting an institution track its file. It published its queue with it: 546 applications as at 10 July 2026, of which about 250 are expected at the commission session opening on 21 September 2026.

National statistics

(narrative not yet written)

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The Council of Ministers of 8 July 2026 [adopted a bill overhauling the 2014 cyber law](#) on three axes: protecting the vulnerable, ending digital impunity through revised electronic evidence, connection-data retention and suspect-asset freezing, and mandatory cooperation with justice by telecommunications, internet and digital-finance operators. The framework was previewed at the [first national cybersecurity symposium in June](#), which defined security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations. The bill is not enacted.

The same Council [ordered internet service providers to block pornographic sites](#) on public-order grounds, the executive holding that such content favours the resurgence of delinquency and degrades the security climate. Ministries and public bodies are told to implement it. It is a cabinet decision, not a law, and no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route is specified. It follows a May 2026 ministerial warning and a 15 June announcement of a dedicated social-media law covering harassment, defamation and disinformation.

Strategies, plans and policies

On 20 July the [Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation](#) was launched at the Palais d'État d'Iavoloha, requested by the presidency and supported by UNDP, running 2026 to 2030, explicitly including the use of digital tools. Administrations had until end-July to submit proposals [through a dedicated digital platform](#); a steering committee screens them and selected interventions run three to nine months. 170 focal points were certified in advance.

Open data

(narrative not yet written)

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

AXIAN Telecom was [named a founding partner of an African-language artificial-intelligence initiative on 28 July 2026](#). No Malagasy-language model or dataset has been released.

A [Madagascar-Egypt government partnership on the use of artificial intelligence in public administration and the sector's digital transition was reported on 1 August](#), with no date of signature given.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

The month's only market measurement came from an operator: MVola's director general put the whole Malagasy mobile-money market at [six to seven million active users against a population of about thirty million, with rural areas under-served](#), and set doubling or tripling that as the five-to-ten-year test.

Training and skills

The digital ministry [received 259 applications by 1 August 2026 for ten established civil-service posts](#), split between the capital and the regional directorates. The fields are artificial intelligence, data management, digital innovation, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law, the last covering personal data protection and electronic commerce. Applicants have publicly asked for integrity guarantees on the selection, and no appointment has been announced.

Finance

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